

Controlling SELinux

The *getenforce* command gets the current mode of SELinux. It reports whether SELinux is Enforcing, Permissive, or Disabled. On a system with SELinux disabled, it will display the following:

```
[root@station20 ~]# getenforce
Disabled
```

On a system with SELinux in Permissive Mode, it will display:

```
[root@jvbg ~]# getenforce
Permissive
```

On a system with SELinux in Enforcing Mode, the following will be displayed:

```
[root@jvbg ~]# getenforce
Enforcing
```

setenforce modifies the mode SELinux is running in. It is used to toggle between Permissive and Enforcing mode when SELinux is enabled.

To activate "Enforcing mode" on an SELinux-enabled system, run:

```
[root@jvbg ~]# setenforce 1
```

To check the current status, use *getenforce*. To activate Permissive SELinux mode, execute:

```
[root@jvbg ~]# setenforce 0
```

The *sestatus* command is used to get the status of a system running SELinux. Apart from mentioning the current mode of SELinux, it gives more information about the SELinux policy.

On a system with SELinux disabled, it will display:

```
[root@station20 ~]# sestatus
SELinux status:      disabled
```

On a System with SELinux in Permissive Mode, it will display:

```
[root@jvbg ~]# sestatus
SELinux status:      enabled
SELinuxfs mount:     /selinux
Current mode:         permissive
Mode from config file: permissive
Policy version:       21
Policy from config file: targeted
```

The first line informs us that SELinux is enabled in this system.

The second line is of great significance. It displays the mount point of the SELinux pseudo file system. This file system is quite like the *proc* and *sys* file systems, and contains run-time information about your SELinux mode and various other things.

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SCO M-22, Second Floor Old DLF Colony,
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